



Newly-elected Prime Minister Rahul Gandhi addresses the nation from a villager's hut



The Jet Kingfisher merger sees the new no-frills airline being renamed FisherPrice

embedded in the headboard of the best time to have sex. Sex, however, is the last thing on Bharat's mind. He is running really late and he hastily switches off the hologram tv beamed on to his bedroom wall and makes his way to the car park where his Nano is stacked up along with 30 other vehicles in the vertical car lift introduced by the Delhi government to ease the city's parking crisis. It clearly isn't going to be his day. His Nano, which has just become the world's largest selling car after oil prices reached \$200 a barrel, is second from top. It usually takes just a few minutes but the crippling power shortages mean that the first of many scheduled power cuts has commenced and Bharat now has to wait for manual operation which adds another 30 minutes to his delayed departure.

Facing the prospect of missing a key meeting, Bharat rings for a cab registered on his mobile phone service and heads to the nearby Ansal Plaza to take the Commuter Chopper to his office in Connaught Place. The cc, as it is called, is the new service launched by the Delhi government using Russian Mi-24 helicopters which can carry 30 passengers at a time to and from various key points in the city. The service was introduced after the city infrastructure failed to cope with the massive increase in the

number of cars on Delhi roads, leading to humungous traffic jams. Similar services have been introduced in Mumbai, Bangalore, Hyderabad and Kolkata. For Bharat, the time saved is worth the extra cost. He can, of course, opt to work from home. The Great Recession which started in September 2008 has lasted far longer than most had predicted and companies are encouraging staff to work from home to save on costs like electricity, petrol and incidentals like peons and catering. Bharat, however, is hooked to his workplace at E-Uphoria, the Bangalore-based start-up that has achieved huge success by selling wellness and happiness through technology.

Bharat's office showcases the company's products. His desk comes with a built-in treadmill so he can exercise while scanning his e-mails, voice-mails, twitters and also social networking. His chair is wired to measure stress levels so he can take a break, reduce his workload or enter the Cocoon, a shell-like device that allows you to de-stress by cutting you off from the real world while listening to soothing sounds. The latest addition is the e-office alert, a scanner near his workstation that registers his arrival downstairs via web-cameras and alerts his computer which boots up and opens the

Bharat is frantic having misplaced his Unique Identification Card launched by Nandan Nilekani. It is mandatory for all citizens and required for all transactions. Losing the uic is almost a criminal offence.



He finds it under his e-mattress which monitors various parameters and signals couples on the best time to have sex

He could work from home under the post-recession regulations but his hi-tech office beckons

